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June 22, 2026

THE DEPARTMENT OF HOME AFFAIRS
Australia

Subject: Endorsement of Mr. Muhammad Zeeshan for the National Innovation Visa

Dear Sir/Madam,

My name is Zia Rehman and I am a Supervisor Project Engineer at Saudi Aramco, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. I am a seasoned project management professional with more than 32 years of experience managing large-scale infrastructure and technology projects valued at over USD 2 billion. My expertise spans the delivery of complex projects including cross-country crude oil, gas, and product pipelines, bulk plants, distribution hubs, electrical substations, civil infrastructure, gas compression facilities, fire protection systems, security systems, and associated technologies.

Prior to joining Saudi Aramco, I held several engineering and management positions in the telecommunications industry within the United States where I was responsible for the design, deployment, and management of wireless and cellular networks across multiple states including New York, Washington, California, Wisconsin, Minnesota, Idaho, Florida, and Georgia.

Throughout my professional career, I have held the following senior technical and managerial positions:

- Supervisor Project Engineer, Saudi Aramco, Dhahran, Saudi Arabia (May 2001 – Present)
- Engineering Manager, Nortel Networks, Seattle, Washington, USA (May 2000 – May 2001)
- Project Engineer, Dobson Communications (AT&T), Poughkeepsie, New York, USA (May 1999 – May 2000)
- Engineering Manager, Palmer Wireless, Fort Myers, Florida, USA (May 1995 – April 1999)
- Project Engineer, US Cellular, Chicago, Illinois, USA (May 1994 – June 1995)

I also hold a Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering from University of Illinois Chicago.

I have known Mr. Muhammad Zeeshan since 2009 through our professional collaboration at Saudi Aramco. As the Project Manager overseeing security and intelligent transportation projects including the Plate Recognition System (PRS) for Saudi Aramco critical plants, I worked closely with Mr. Zeeshan who served as the Lead Software Engineer and Technical Architect for the solution.

Mr. Zeeshan was responsible for the system architecture, software design, deployment strategy, and technical leadership of this mission-critical platform. He consistently demonstrated exceptional technical expertise, innovation, and leadership while managing technical discussions, including FAT (Factory Acceptance Testing) and SAT (Site Acceptance Testing) activities, and the successful commissioning of the system across multiple locations.

One of his most significant achievements was leading the delivery and long-term operation of a Vehicle License Plate Recognition System (PRS) deployment spanning more than 34 locations

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and over 100 traffic lanes across Saudi Arabia. The system substantially improved vehicle access management, security monitoring, and operational efficiency within Saudi Aramco critical facilities, and its continued success reflects the robustness of the architecture and engineering standards established by Mr. Zeeshan.

Throughout our association, I have observed his extensive expertise in software engineering, ANPR (Automatic Number Plate Recognition) technologies, intelligent transportation systems, enterprise platforms, and high-availability architecture. He combines strong technical capabilities with excellent communication, stakeholder management, and leadership skills.

Based on my firsthand experience working with him over many years, I believe Mr. Zeeshan would make a valuable contribution to Australia's technology and innovation ecosystem. His expertise in ANPR (Automatic Number Plate Recognition), intelligent transportation systems, software architecture, and large-scale enterprise solutions aligns strongly with Australia's priorities in smart infrastructure, public safety, and digital transformation for building "Smart Cities".

I, therefore, offer my strongest endorsement of Mr. Muhammad Zeeshan's application for the National Innovation Visa and highly recommend him for favorable consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Zia Rehman

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